

More About Plotly and the GitHub API

Plotly's documentation is extensive and well organized; however, it can be hard to know where to start reading. A good place to start is with the article "Plotly Express in Python," at <https://plotly.com/python/plotly-express>. This is an overview of all the plots you can make with Plotly Express, and you can find links to longer articles about each individual chart type.

If you want to understand how to customize Plotly charts better, the article "Styling Plotly Express Figures in Python" will expand on what you've seen in Chapters 15–17. You can find this article at <https://plotly.com/python/styling-plotly-express>.

For more about the GitHub API, refer to its documentation at <https://docs.github.com/en/rest>. Here you'll learn how to pull a wide variety of information from GitHub. To expand on what you saw in this project, look for the Search section of the reference in the sidebar. If you have a GitHub account, you can work with your own data as well as the publicly available data from other users' repositories.

The Hacker News API

To explore how to use API calls on other sites, let's take a quick look at Hacker News (<https://news.ycombinator.com>). On Hacker News, people share articles about programming and technology and engage in lively discussions about those articles. The Hacker News API provides access to data about all submissions and comments on the site, and you can use the API without having to register for a key.

The following call returns information about the current top article as of this writing:

```
https://hacker-news.firebaseio.com/v0/item/31353677.json
```

When you enter this URL in a browser, you'll see that the text on the page is enclosed by braces, meaning it's a dictionary. But the response is difficult to examine without some better formatting. Let's run this URL through the `json.dumps()` method, like we did in the earthquake project in Chapter 16, so we can explore the kind of information that's returned about an article:

```
hn_article.py import requests
import json

# Make an API call, and store the response.
url = "https://hacker-news.firebaseio.com/v0/item/31353677.json"
r = requests.get(url)
print(f"Status code: {r.status_code}")

# Explore the structure of the data.
response_dict = r.json()
response_string = json.dumps(response_dict, indent=4)
❶ print(response_string)
```
